

Complete Weierstrass elliptic function solutions for coherent couplers and their relation to degenerate four-wave mixing

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Abstract

Complete analytic solutions for the coherent coupler with arbitrary propagation constants and self- and cross-phase modulation coefficients are presented in terms of Weierstrass elliptic $\wp$, ζ , and σ functions, giving the full complex envelopes for both modes under generic initial conditions. Jensen's coupler emerges as a special case of the general system. The mode solutions contain factors of the form $\exp(r \log R(z))$, where $R(z)$ is a ratio of Weierstrass σ functions, giving a multi-valued branch structure that is removable by a gauge transformation. A projection from the three-mode degenerate four-wave mixing system onto the two-mode coupler is identified, and the corresponding degenerate-system solutions are single-valued meromorphic Kronecker theta functions. This connection establishes the coherent coupler as a reduction of a broader class of integrable parametric processes and opens a pathway to leveraging known expansions of Kronecker theta functions for further analysis of nonlinear coupler dynamics.

1 Introduction

The coherent coupler is one of the canonical nonlinear optical systems, describing the exchange of optical power between two evanescently coupled waveguide modes under the Kerr nonlinearity. In the seminal work of Jensen [1], the coupled-mode equations were analysed to reveal power-dependent switching behaviour, establishing the nonlinear coupler as a prototype device for all-optical signal processing. Despite this long history, closed-form analytic solutions for the full complex envelopes of both modes have, to our knowledge, not previously been reported for the general system with arbitrary propagation constants and distinct self- and cross-phase modulation coefficients.

Most existing analytic treatments of the coupler follow the approach of Jensen and decompose the dynamics into modal powers and relative phase, leading to a single equation for the power in one waveguide that can be inverted in terms of Jacobi elliptic functions [1]. While this yields the power evolution exactly, it does not directly provide the complex envelopes, and the analysis is typically restricted to the symmetric case in which the two modes share identical propagation constants and nonlinear coefficients. The generalisation to asymmetric couplers introduces additional parameters that complicate the Jacobi elliptic function approach, and solutions for the complex envelopes in this general setting have remained elusive.

The present work derives complete solutions for the complex envelopes of the general asymmetric coupler using Weierstrass elliptic functions. This work is part of a series of papers by the author that provide complete general solutions to coupled mode systems of nonlinear ordinary differential equations in quasi-continuous-wave nonlinear optics that include linearly polarised (LP) modes of a multimode optical fiber [2]; two-wave and three-wave mixing in quadratic nonlinear media, polarisation dynamics in nonlinear fibres, and parity-time symmetric nonlinear couplers [3]; and four-wave mixing in an optical fiber [4]. The Weierstrass formulation provides

a natural solution pathway in such systems: the coupled equations are recast as logarithmic derivatives, which directly yield Weierstrass ζ functions, and integration produces solutions expressed as ratios of Weierstrass σ functions. This progression through the Weierstrass hierarchy, from $\wp$ to ζ to σ , follows naturally from the structure of the complex envelope equations. In the case of the coherent coupler considered herein, the resulting solutions contain factors of the form $\exp(r \log R(z))$, where $R(z)$ is a ratio of σ functions, producing multi-valued branching; we show that a gauge transformation removes this behaviour, yielding a cleaner canonical form. The exact Weierstrass elliptic function solutions for the general asymmetric coupler constitute the first main result of this paper.

The second main result concerns the relationship between the coherent coupler and degenerate four-wave mixing (FWM). Degenerate FWM is a three-mode parametric process in which two photons from a common pump are converted into a signal-idler pair, governed by a system of coupled-mode equations that is known to be integrable [5, 4]. We identify a projection from this three-mode system onto the two-mode coupler equations, establishing that the coupler is a reduction of the degenerate FWM system. Under this projection, the solutions in the degenerate system take the form of single-valued meromorphic Kronecker theta functions [3], a class of functions that appears across several integrable nonlinear optical systems including wave mixing in quadratic media and polarisation dynamics. This connection situates the coherent coupler within a broader integrable structure and suggests that the mathematical framework developed here may extend to other parametric processes.

The paper is organised as follows. Section 2 recalls Jensen’s coherent coupler and Section 3 introduces the generalised two-mode system. Sections 4–6 derive the conserved quantities, modal-power solution, and full complex-envelope solutions. Section 7 establishes the projection from degenerate FWM and the Kronecker theta function form of the solutions. Section 8 presents numerical validation, and Section 9 concludes with a discussion of implications and possible extensions.

2 Jensen’s coherent coupler system

In this section we recall the coherent coupler system from Jensen’s classic paper [1] that forms the starting point for our study. Jensen’s system of ordinary differential equations, shown in (2.1), describes propagation in the quasi-continuous-wave limit, i.e., when temporal envelope variations are negligible compared to the spatial evolution along the propagation direction, allowing time derivatives to be neglected. Physically, the equations govern the evolution of optical waves travelling in two waveguides placed close together, which exchange energy through coherent coupling of their evanescent fields. This interaction is modelled by the linear coupling terms parameterised by Ω_2 . Each wave also experiences self-phase modulation (SPM), where its own intensity induces a phase shift on itself, and cross-phase modulation (XPM), where the intensity of the other wave induces an additional phase shift. The system is described by the following coupled mode equations:

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{dA_1}{dZ} &= i (|A_1|^2 \Omega_3 + 2|A_2|^2 \Omega_4) A_1 + i\Omega_1 A_1 + i\Omega_2 A_2, \\ \frac{dA_2}{dZ} &= i (2|A_1|^2 \Omega_4 + |A_2|^2 \Omega_3) A_2 + i\Omega_2 A_1 + i\Omega_1 A_2,\end{aligned}\tag{2.1}$$

where:

- A_j with $j = 1, 2$ are the slowly-varying complex field amplitudes
- Z is the propagation distance
- Ω_1 is the common propagation constant

- Ω_2 is the linear coupling coefficient
- Ω_3 is the self-phase modulation (SPM) coefficient
- Ω_4 is the cross-phase modulation (XPM) coefficient.

We refer the reader to [1] for details on how to express the Ω_j coefficients in terms of material parameters and overlap integrals. Jensen states that the waveguides in (2.1) were taken to be identical in order to simplify analysis and obtain solutions in standard elliptic integrals, hence the symmetry in the parameters in the two equations. In this work, however, we analytically solve a generalised system that does not enforce this symmetry. Jensen's system emerges as a special case. We present the generalised system in the next section.

3 The generalised coherent coupler

In this section we normalise and generalise Jensen's system given in (2.1) to arbitrary coefficients to broaden the scope of applicability. We use the same notation as in [4] for a general FWM system, the only difference being that here there are two modes rather than four, so the mode index j takes values 1, 2, whereas in the FWM case $j = 1, 2, 3, 4$. The system that we will consider is thus:

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{d}{dz}u_j(z) &= -\left(a_j + \sum_{k=1}^2 a_{j,k} u_k v_k\right) u_j + \prod_{k=1, k \neq j}^2 v_k, \\ \frac{d}{dz}v_j(z) &= \left(a_j + \sum_{k=1}^2 a_{j,k} u_k v_k\right) v_j - \prod_{k=1, k \neq j}^2 u_k,\end{aligned}\tag{3.1}$$

where we refer to the parameters $a_j, a_{j,k} \in \mathbb{C}$ as propagation constants and phase modulation parameters, respectively, and take $a_{2,1} = a_{1,2}$. As there are only two modes, the product of modes governing wave mixing in (3.1) only contains one term and that term provides the linear coupling. Jensen's system in (2.1) is recovered from (3.1) by introducing the original Jensen propagation coordinate $Z = z/\Omega_2$ and making the following substitutions:

$$\begin{aligned}a_1 &= -a_2 = -\frac{i\Omega_1}{\Omega_2}, \\ a_{1,1} &= a_{2,2} = \frac{i\Omega_3}{\Omega_2}, \\ a_{1,2} &= a_{2,1} = -\frac{2i\Omega_4}{\Omega_2}, \\ u_1(z) &= A_1(Z)e^{-\frac{i\pi}{4}}, \\ u_2(z) &= A_2^*(Z)e^{-\frac{i\pi}{4}}, \\ v_1(z) &= -A_1^*(Z)e^{\frac{i\pi}{4}}, \\ v_2(z) &= A_2(Z)e^{\frac{i\pi}{4}},\end{aligned}\tag{3.2}$$

where A^* denotes the complex conjugate and $z = \Omega_2 Z$ is the rescaled coordinate used in (3.1). Therefore, Jensen's system in (2.1) is a special case of the more general system in (3.1).

In the following sections we provide the complete analytic solution for the generalised system in (3.1). Following our approach in [4], from this point on we do not assume that u_j and v_j are necessarily complex conjugates, but we will show in the following section that they are Hamiltonian conjugates with physical systems such as Jensen's being a particular realisation of a more general system. In all that follows we refer to u_j, v_j as modes, which we use as a general term for components of the coupled system. We refer to their product $u_j v_j$ as the modal power; while this quantity is not necessarily real-valued, the conceptual analogy is useful.

4 Conserved quantities

In this section we identify conserved quantities of the system. The approach and notation follow that of [4], adjusted for two modes instead of four. The system in (3.1) can be formulated as the following canonical Hamiltonian system:

$$H(u_1, u_2, v_1, v_2) = - \sum_{j=1}^2 a_j u_j v_j - \frac{1}{2} \sum_{j,k=1}^2 a_{j,k} u_j v_j u_k v_k + \prod_{j=1}^2 u_j + \prod_{j=1}^2 v_j, \quad (4.1)$$

$$\frac{d}{dz} u_j(z) = \frac{\partial H}{\partial v_j}, \quad (4.2)$$

$$\frac{d}{dz} v_j(z) = - \frac{\partial H}{\partial u_j}, \quad (4.3)$$

$$\frac{d}{dz} H = 0 \quad (4.4)$$

The conservation of H is to be expected as a consequence of (4.1) lacking an explicit z dependence. The pair u_j, v_j are Hamiltonian conjugates, and each pair represents one of two degrees of freedom in the system. The modal power $u_j v_j$ evolves according to:

$$\frac{d}{dz} (u_j v_j) = - \prod_{k=1}^2 u_k + \prod_{k=1}^2 v_k \quad (4.5)$$

As the right-hand side of (4.5) is the same for all j , we may define constants γ_j and a function $\rho(z)$ such that:

$$u_j(z) v_j(z) = \gamma_j - \rho(z) \quad (4.6)$$

from which it follows that there is an intermodal power conservation law of the form:

$$u_1(z) v_1(z) - u_2(z) v_2(z) = \gamma_1 - \gamma_2. \quad (4.7)$$

Together, the Hamiltonian H and the intermodal power difference in (4.7) give the two conserved quantities expected for an integrable two-degree-of-freedom Hamiltonian system [6]. The constants γ_j are determined only up to a common additive shift, since the transformation $\gamma_j \mapsto \gamma_j + c$ and $\rho(z) \mapsto \rho(z) + c$ leaves (4.6) unchanged. We choose to impose the constraint that:

$$\sum_{j=1}^2 \gamma_j = 0, \quad (4.8)$$

after which $\rho(z)$ is minus the mean modal power and γ_j is the constant difference between a mode's modal power and the mean.

5 Solutions for modal powers in terms of Weierstrass $\wp$ elliptic functions

In this section we give analytic solutions for the modal powers. As in the previous section, the approach and notation closely follow that of [4], adjusted for two modes instead of four. The fundamental Weierstrass elliptic function theory used in this and subsequent sections can be found in [7]. In order to obtain elliptic function solutions in wave mixing dynamics, the key observation is that the derivative of the modal power in (4.5) is proportional to the difference of the two wave mixing product terms, and that the Hamiltonian in (4.1) contains their sum. We then note the simple but important identity:

$$\left(\prod_{k=1}^2 u_k - \prod_{k=1}^2 v_k \right)^2 - \left(\prod_{k=1}^2 u_k + \prod_{k=1}^2 v_k \right)^2 = -4 \prod_{j=1}^2 u_j v_j \quad (5.1)$$

which enables us to square (4.5) and replace wave mixing terms with phase modulation terms, i.e., monomials of $u_j v_j$ which can all be expressed in terms of $\rho(z)$ via (4.6). To proceed in this manner, let us introduce the function Q which represents the phase modulation part of the Hamiltonian and is thus itself expressible as a polynomial of $\rho(z)$:

$$\begin{aligned} Q(u_1(z)v_1(z), u_2(z)v_2(z)) &= a_0 + \sum_{j=1}^2 a_j u_j v_j + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{j,k=1}^2 a_{j,k} u_j v_j u_k v_k, \\ &= \sum_{l=0}^2 b_l \rho(z)^l \end{aligned} \quad (5.2)$$

where $a_0 = H$ is introduced so that the conserved Hamiltonian appears as the constant term of the polynomial. Observe that squaring (4.5) and substituting (4.1), (4.6), (5.1), and (5.2) gives:

$$\left(\frac{d}{dz} \rho(z) \right)^2 = Q^2(\gamma_1 - \rho(z), \gamma_2 - \rho(z)) - 4 \prod_{j=1}^2 (\gamma_j - \rho(z)), \quad (5.3)$$

$$\left(\frac{d}{dz} \rho(z) \right)^2 = \left(\sum_{l=0}^2 b_l \rho(z)^l \right)^2 - 4 \prod_{j=1}^2 (\gamma_j - \rho(z)), \quad (5.4)$$

$$\left(\frac{d}{dz} \rho(z) \right)^2 = \sum_{l=0}^4 d_l \rho(z)^l, \quad (5.5)$$

$$\left(\frac{d}{dz} \rho(z) \right)^2 = d_4 \prod_{l=1}^4 (\rho(z) - \lambda_l), \quad (5.6)$$

where b_l and d_l are given in terms of other parameters and initial conditions in Appendices A and B, and where λ_l are the roots of the quartic polynomial in $\rho(z)$, i.e.:

$$\sum_{k=0}^4 d_k \lambda_l^k = 0 \quad (5.7)$$

Equation (5.6) is a differential equation whose generic solution is elliptic. By separating phase modulation and wave mixing terms in the Hamiltonian, and by exploiting intermodal power conservation, we obtain it directly without first inverting elliptic integrals. To solve it, we now transform (5.6) from quartic to the standard cubic form of the Weierstrass $\wp$ function using the classical trick which can be conceptualised in three steps [7]:

$$\begin{aligned} (1) \text{ shift by any root so RHS is 0 when } q(z) &= 0 & \rho(z) &= q(z) + \lambda_1, \\ (2) \text{ invert to reduce the quartic to a cubic} & & s(z) &= \frac{1}{q(z)}, \\ (3) \text{ shift and scale to match Weierstrass coefficients} & & w(z) &= C_1 s(z) + C_0. \end{aligned} \quad (5.8)$$

For definiteness and without loss of generality, we choose the root λ_1 . The procedure

sketched in (5.8) is then implemented in the following single transformation:

$$\rho(z) = \lambda_1 + \frac{d_4}{-4w(z) \prod_{l=1}^3 \Delta_l + \frac{d_4}{3} \sum_{l=1}^3 \Delta_l}, \quad (5.9)$$

$$\Delta_l = \frac{1}{\lambda_{l+1} - \lambda_1},$$

$$\left(\frac{d}{dz} w(z) \right)^2 = 4w(z)^3 - g_2 w(z) - g_3, \quad (5.10)$$

$$g_2 = d_0 d_4 - \frac{d_1 d_3}{4} + \frac{d_2^2}{12}, \quad (5.11)$$

$$g_3 = \frac{d_0 d_2 d_4}{6} - \frac{d_0 d_3^2}{16} - \frac{d_1^2 d_4}{16} + \frac{d_1 d_2 d_3}{48} - \frac{d_2^3}{216} \quad (5.12)$$

where the constants g_2 and g_3 are known as Weierstrass elliptic invariants. Equation (5.10) defines the Weierstrass elliptic $\wp$ function and the solution is:

$$w(z) = \wp(z - z_0, g_2, g_3) \quad (5.13)$$

where z_0 is a constant chosen to match initial conditions. The constant z_0 , and the other special points introduced below, can be obtained by inverting $\wp$ using an elliptic integral [7]. As $\wp$ is an even function, it is necessary to also specify a corresponding condition for the derivative when inverting to fix the sign, i.e., to find z from known x, y we give conditions such as $\wp(z) = x, \wp'(z) = y$, where $\wp'$ is the derivative of $\wp$. From elliptic function theory, the points obtained during such an inversion are determined modulo the period lattice of the doubly periodic $\wp$ function. In addition to z_0 , we introduce two other types of special points that characterize the solution structure and enable the use of elliptic function identities to solve for the modes in Section 6. The point $z_0 + z_1$ corresponds to the pole of $\rho(z)$ where the denominator in (5.9) vanishes. The points μ_j are the locations where individual modal powers vanish, $u_j(\mu_j)v_j(\mu_j) = 0$, and thus where $\rho(\mu_j) = \gamma_j$ from (4.6). These special points are defined implicitly through their Weierstrass function values:

$$\begin{aligned} \wp(z_0) &= \frac{d_2}{12} + \frac{d_3 \lambda_1}{4} + \frac{d_4 \lambda_1^2}{2} + \frac{-d_1 - 2d_2 \lambda_1 - 3d_3 \lambda_1^2 - 4d_4 \lambda_1^3}{4(-\rho(0) + \lambda_1)}, \\ \wp'(z_0) &= \frac{(d_1 + 2d_2 \lambda_1 + 3d_3 \lambda_1^2 + 4d_4 \lambda_1^3)}{4(\rho(0) - \lambda_1)^2} \left. \frac{d}{dz} \rho(z) \right|_{z=0}, \\ \wp(z_1) &= \frac{d_2}{12} + \frac{d_3 \lambda_1}{4} + \frac{d_4 \lambda_1^2}{2}, \\ \wp'(z_1) &= \frac{(-d_1 - 2d_2 \lambda_1 - 3d_3 \lambda_1^2 - 4d_4 \lambda_1^3) b_2}{4}, \\ \wp(\mu_j - z_0) &= \frac{d_2}{12} + \frac{d_3 \lambda_1}{4} + \frac{d_4 \lambda_1^2}{2} - \frac{-d_1 - 2d_2 \lambda_1 - 3d_3 \lambda_1^2 - 4d_4 \lambda_1^3}{4(\gamma_j - \lambda_1)}, \\ \wp'(\mu_j - z_0) &= -\frac{(b_0 + b_1 \gamma_j + b_2 \gamma_j^2)(d_1 + 2d_2 \lambda_1 + 3d_3 \lambda_1^2 + 4d_4 \lambda_1^3)}{4(\gamma_j - \lambda_1)^2}. \end{aligned} \quad (5.14)$$

The solutions for modal powers are then found from (4.6) and (5.9) to be:

$$\begin{aligned} u_j(z)v_j(z) &= \rho(\mu_j) - \rho(z), \\ &= \frac{\wp'(z_1)}{b_2(\wp(z_1) - \wp(\mu_j - z_0))} - \frac{\wp'(z_1)}{b_2(\wp(z_1) - \wp(z - z_0))}, \\ &= \frac{\wp'(z_1)}{b_2(\wp(z_1) - \wp(\mu_j - z_0))} \frac{(\wp(z - z_0) - \wp(\mu_j - z_0))}{(\wp(z - z_0) - \wp(z_1))}. \end{aligned} \quad (5.15)$$

6 Solutions for modes in terms of Weierstrass σ , ζ functions

Having obtained the modal power solutions in the previous section, we now proceed to find solutions for the individual modes $u_j(z)$ and $v_j(z)$ themselves. Direct substitution of (4.1), (4.5), (4.6), and (4.7) into (3.1) shows that the equations can be recast in terms of logarithmic derivatives:

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\frac{\partial}{\partial z} u_j(z)}{u_j(z)} &= \frac{1}{2} \frac{\rho'(z) - \rho'(\mu_j)}{\rho(z) - \rho(\mu_j)} + \rho(z)\Lambda_{1,j} + \Lambda_{0,j}, \\ \frac{\frac{\partial}{\partial z} v_j(z)}{v_j(z)} &= \frac{1}{2} \frac{\rho'(z) + \rho'(\mu_j)}{\rho(z) - \rho(\mu_j)} - \rho(z)\Lambda_{1,j} - \Lambda_{0,j},\end{aligned}\tag{6.1}$$

$$\Lambda_{0,j} = -a_j - \frac{\gamma_j}{4} \sum_{\substack{1 \leq k \leq 2 \\ 1 \leq l \leq 2}} a_{k,l} - \sum_{l=1}^2 a_{j,l} \gamma_l + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{k=1}^2 a_{k,k} \gamma_k + \sum_{k=1}^2 \frac{a_k}{2},\tag{6.2}$$

$$\Lambda_{1,j} = \sum_{k=1}^2 a_{j,k} - \frac{1}{4} \sum_{\substack{1 \leq k \leq 2 \\ 1 \leq l \leq 2}} a_{k,l},\tag{6.3}$$

where the right-hand side is expressed purely in terms of ρ and its derivative ρ' . This logarithmic derivative form is advantageous because it can be integrated directly to yield solutions in terms of Weierstrass σ functions, as we now show.

We substitute the modal power solution (5.15) into (6.1) and apply the elliptic function identity:

$$\frac{\wp'(x, g_2, g_3)}{\wp(x, g_2, g_3) - \wp(y, g_2, g_3)} = \zeta(x + y, g_2, g_3) + \zeta(x - y, g_2, g_3) - 2\zeta(x, g_2, g_3)\tag{6.4}$$

which allows us to express the right-hand side in terms of Weierstrass ζ functions and constants:

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\frac{\partial}{\partial z} u_j(z)}{u_j(z)} &= \frac{(\zeta(z - z_0 + z_1) - 2\zeta(z_1) - \zeta(z - z_0 - z_1)) \Lambda_{1,j}}{b_2} \\ &\quad + \zeta(z - 2z_0 + \mu_j) - \frac{\zeta(z - z_0 - z_1)}{2} - \frac{\zeta(z - z_0 + z_1)}{2} \\ &\quad - \frac{\zeta(\mu_j - z_0 - z_1)}{2} - \frac{\zeta(\mu_j - z_0 + z_1)}{2} + \Lambda_{0,j} + \Lambda_{1,j} \lambda_1 \\ \frac{\frac{\partial}{\partial z} v_j(z)}{v_j(z)} &= - \frac{(\zeta(z - z_0 + z_1) - 2\zeta(z_1) - \zeta(z - z_0 - z_1)) \Lambda_{1,j}}{b_2} \\ &\quad + \zeta(z - \mu_j) - \frac{\zeta(z - z_0 - z_1)}{2} - \frac{\zeta(z - z_0 + z_1)}{2} \\ &\quad + \frac{\zeta(\mu_j - z_0 - z_1)}{2} + \frac{\zeta(\mu_j - z_0 + z_1)}{2} - \Lambda_{0,j} - \Lambda_{1,j} \lambda_1.\end{aligned}\tag{6.5}$$

Equations (6.5) can be integrated by noting that the Weierstrass ζ function is the logarithmic derivative of the Weierstrass σ function:

$$\zeta(z, g_2, g_3) = \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \log(\sigma(z, g_2, g_3)).\tag{6.6}$$

Performing the integration and taking exponentials gives the first main result of this paper, the complete analytic solutions for the complex mode envelopes u_j, v_j without decomposition into

amplitude and phase:

$$\begin{aligned}
u_j(z) &= \frac{\alpha_j \sqrt{W_j} \sigma(z - 2z_0 + \mu_j) \exp \left(z r_{0,j} + \log \left(\frac{\sigma(z - z_0 + z_1)}{\sigma(z - z_0 - z_1)} \right) r_{1,j} \right)}{\sqrt{\wp(z_1) - \wp(z - z_0)} \sigma(\mu_j - z_0) \sigma(z - z_0)}, \\
v_j(z) &= \frac{\sqrt{W_j} \sigma(z - \mu_j) \exp \left(-z r_{0,j} - \log \left(\frac{\sigma(z - z_0 + z_1)}{\sigma(z - z_0 - z_1)} \right) r_{1,j} \right)}{\alpha_j \sqrt{\wp(z_1) - \wp(z - z_0)} \sigma(\mu_j - z_0) \sigma(z - z_0)}
\end{aligned} \tag{6.7}$$

or equivalently:

$$\begin{aligned}
u_j(z) &= \frac{\kappa \alpha_j \sqrt{W_j} \sigma(z_1) \sigma(z - 2z_0 + \mu_j) \exp \left(z r_{0,j} + \log \left(\frac{\sigma(z - z_0 + z_1)}{\sigma(z - z_0 - z_1)} \right) \left(r_{1,j} - \frac{1}{2} \right) \right)}{\sigma(\mu_j - z_0) \sigma(z - z_0 - z_1)}, \\
v_j(z) &= \frac{\sqrt{W_j} \sigma(z_1) \sigma(z - \mu_j) \exp \left(-z r_{0,j} - \log \left(\frac{\sigma(z - z_0 + z_1)}{\sigma(z - z_0 - z_1)} \right) \left(r_{1,j} - \frac{1}{2} \right) \right)}{\kappa \alpha_j \sigma(\mu_j - z_0) \sigma(z - z_0 + z_1)}
\end{aligned} \tag{6.8}$$

where the branch of the logarithm is chosen continuously along the integration path from $z = 0$, α_j is the integration constant that can be fixed by initial conditions to capture any phase offset between a mode and its Hamiltonian conjugate, and square-root branches are chosen consistently with the same initial conditions. The other constants are:

$$\begin{aligned}
W_j &= \frac{\wp'(z_1)}{b_2 (\wp(z_1) - \wp(\mu_j - z_0))}, \\
r_{0,j} &= \Lambda_{0,j} + \Lambda_{1,j} \lambda_1 - \frac{2\zeta(z_1) \Lambda_{1,j}}{b_2} - \frac{\zeta(\mu_j - z_0 - z_1)}{2} - \frac{\zeta(\mu_j - z_0 + z_1)}{2}, \\
r_{1,j} &= \frac{\Lambda_{1,j}}{b_2}, \\
\kappa &= \frac{\sqrt{\wp(z_1) - \wp(z_0)} \sigma(z_0) \sigma(z_1)}{\sqrt{\frac{\sigma(z_0 - z_1)}{\sigma(z_0 + z_1)}} \sigma(z_0 + z_1)} = \pm 1
\end{aligned} \tag{6.9}$$

and it can be shown that:

$$\sum_{j=1}^2 r_{1,j} = 1. \tag{6.10}$$

These formulae give the generic non-degenerate solutions without approximation.

We show in Appendix C that the Hamiltonian (4.1) can be expressed as the Frobenius–Stickelberger determinant, a classical identity relating products of Weierstrass σ functions to determinants of derivatives of $\wp$. This provides a deeper structural understanding of how the Hamiltonian is conserved and connects the coherent coupler system to the broader theory of elliptic functions.

6.1 Jensen’s special case

In Jensen’s case, there is notable simplification in the solutions as the waveguides are made identical. In our notation, this translates into additional symmetries among a_j and $a_{j,k}$ parameters as specified by their relation to Jensen’s parameters in (3.2). These symmetries further translate into $b_1 = 0$, $2\Lambda_{1,j} = b_2$, and importantly $r_{1,j} = \frac{1}{2}$, which in (6.8) can be seen to eliminate the logarithmic term in the exponentials, thereby removing the branching behaviour, reducing the solutions to a ratio of sigma functions, and thus, meromorphic functions. We show in the next section that the branching behaviour can also be removed in the general case via gauge transform.

7 Relating the coherent coupler to degenerate FWM

In this section we present the second main result of this paper: a transformation from the coherent coupler to a canonical form in which solutions are meromorphic and a projection from degenerate FWM onto that form. The structure of the analytic solutions in (6.8) naturally suggests this transformation. We proceed in two steps: first we remove cross-phase modulation by a gauge transformation, and then we identify the resulting two-mode system as a projection of a degenerate FWM system.

7.1 Removing cross-phase modulation with a gauge transform

To begin, let us consider a transform of the system in (3.1) of the following form:

$$\begin{aligned} u_j(z) &= \hat{u}_j(z) e^{-\phi_j(z)}, \\ v_j(z) &= \hat{v}_j(z) e^{\phi_j(z)}, \end{aligned} \quad (7.1)$$

$$\sum_{j=1}^2 \phi_j(z) = 0, \quad (7.2)$$

where transforming the Hamiltonian conjugate with the opposing phase leaves modal powers unchanged, and where the zero-sum condition on ϕ_j ensures that no additional exponential factors appear in the wave-mixing products. We make the following choice for ϕ_j composed of a part linear in z (labelled L) and a part nonlinear in z (labelled NL) (where L and NL are function labels not exponents):

$$N = 2, \quad (7.3)$$

$$\phi_j(z) = \phi_j^L(z) + \phi_j^{NL}(z) \quad (7.4)$$

$$\phi_j^L(z) = z \left(a_j - \frac{1}{N} \sum_{k=1}^N a_k - \frac{\gamma_j}{N} \sum_{l,k=1}^N a_{l,k} \right), \quad (7.5)$$

$$\phi_j^{NL}(z) = \sum_{k=1}^N \left(a_{j,k} - \frac{1}{N} \sum_{l=1}^N a_{l,k} \right) \int_0^z \hat{u}_k(\xi) \hat{v}_k(\xi) d\xi, \quad (7.6)$$

$$\sum_{j=1}^N \phi_j(z) = \sum_{j=1}^N \phi_j^L(z) = \sum_{j=1}^N \phi_j^{NL}(z) = 0. \quad (7.7)$$

This transforms (3.1) into the following system:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \hat{u}_j &= (b_1 - 2b_2 \hat{u}_j \hat{v}_j) \frac{\hat{u}_j}{N} + \prod_{k=1, k \neq j}^N \hat{v}_k \\ \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \hat{v}_j &= (-b_1 + 2b_2 \hat{u}_j \hat{v}_j) \frac{\hat{v}_j}{N} - \prod_{k=1, k \neq j}^N \hat{u}_k \end{aligned} \quad (7.8)$$

for which the conserved canonical Hamiltonian is:

$$\hat{H} = \prod_{l=1}^N \hat{u}_l + \prod_{l=1}^N \hat{v}_l - \frac{1}{N} \sum_{l=1}^N (b_2 \hat{u}_l^2 \hat{v}_l^2 - b_1 \hat{u}_l \hat{v}_l) \quad (7.9)$$

and the intermodal power conservation law is unchanged such that $\hat{u}_1 \hat{v}_1 - \hat{u}_2 \hat{v}_2 = \gamma_1 - \gamma_2$. To maintain the connection with the original coordinate system the value of $\hat{H}$ would be fixed at:

$$\hat{H} = -\frac{(\gamma_1 - \gamma_2)^2 b_2}{4} + b_0. \quad (7.10)$$

Comparing (7.8) with the original system (3.1), we observe significant simplification. All modes now share a single propagation constant b_1/N and a single self-phase modulation coefficient $2b_2/N$, while all cross-phase modulation terms $a_{j,k}$ with $j \neq k$ have been eliminated. The parameters b_1 and b_2 depend on the conserved constants γ_j ; in the transformed coordinates they therefore encode the chosen power level as well as fibre parameters. In terms of the solutions to the system, the effect of the ϕ_j^{NL} transform is to remove the z -dependent log terms weighted by $r_{1,j}$ in (6.7). This transformation can be interpreted as an analytic form of back-propagation in that it integrates the accumulated cross-phase modulation from all modes along the propagation path and applies conjugate phase shifts to remove these effects, similar to what is implemented digitally to correct nonlinear distortion in fibre optic communication systems, or physically using phase-conjugating optical fibres as explored in [8]. The solutions are:

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{u}_j(z) &= \frac{\hat{\alpha}_j \sqrt{W_j} \sigma(z_1) \sigma(z - 2z_0 + \mu_j) e^{-z(\zeta(\mu_j + z_1 - z_0) + b_2 \gamma_j)}}{\sigma(\mu_j - z_0) \sigma(z - z_0 - z_1)}, \\ \hat{v}_j(z) &= \frac{\sqrt{W_j} \sigma(z_1) \sigma(z - \mu_j) e^{z(\zeta(\mu_j + z_1 - z_0) + b_2 \gamma_j)}}{\hat{\alpha}_j \sigma(\mu_j - z_0) \sigma(z - z_0 + z_1)},\end{aligned}\tag{7.11}$$

where $\hat{\alpha}_j$ are integration constants used to fix initial conditions, the elliptic functions use invariants g_2, g_3 , and $\mu_1, \mu_2, z_0, z_1, g_2, g_3$ share the same definitions and values as those given in Section 5 for the coherent coupler, thereby connecting the two systems. The hatted modes $\hat{u}_j$ have poles at $z = z_0 + z_1$ modulo the lattice, whereas their Hamiltonian conjugates $\hat{v}_j$ have poles at $z = z_0 - z_1$. In other work on FWM [4], we encountered cases where modes and their conjugates share poles at $z = z_0$ and there the modal power is the difference of two Weierstrass $\wp$ functions. This suggests rewriting the ratios in (7.11) as quotients of functions with a common pole at $z = z_0$:

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\sigma(z - 2z_0 + \mu_j)}{\sigma(z - z_0 - z_1)} &= \frac{\left(\frac{\sigma(z - 2z_0 + \mu_j)}{\sigma(z - z_0)}\right)}{\left(\frac{\sigma(z - z_0 - z_1)}{\sigma(z - z_0)}\right)}, \\ \frac{\sigma(z - \mu_j)}{\sigma(z - z_0 + z_1)} &= \frac{\left(\frac{\sigma(z - \mu_j)}{\sigma(z - z_0)}\right)}{\left(\frac{\sigma(z - z_0 + z_1)}{\sigma(z - z_0)}\right)},\end{aligned}\tag{7.12}$$

The sigma-ratio factors on the left of (7.12) are those appearing in the two hatted modes and their conjugates in (7.11), while the factors in parentheses on the right can be interpreted as three modes and their Hamiltonian conjugates, with the denominator factors conjugate to one another. The associated three-mode system is the degenerate FWM system described next.

7.2 Projecting from degenerate FWM to the coherent coupler

We now show how the coherent coupler system in (3.1) arises as a projection of a degenerate four-wave mixing (FWM) system from nonlinear fibre optics.

To start, let us recall that in [4] we showed how quasi-continuous-wave FWM systems can be transformed into the following parameterless non-degenerate canonical Hamiltonian system of four modes $\tilde{u}_j(\xi), j = 1, 2, 3, 4$ with ξ a propagation length variable, and their Hamiltonian conjugates $\tilde{v}_j(\xi)$ (note the tilde notation):

$$\tilde{H} = \sum_{l=1}^4 \left(\frac{1}{8} \tilde{u}_l^2 \tilde{v}_l^2 - \tilde{u}_l \tilde{v}_l \right) - \frac{1}{4} \left(\prod_{l=1}^4 \tilde{u}_l + \prod_{l=1}^4 \tilde{v}_l \right),\tag{7.13}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{\partial}{\partial \xi} \tilde{u}_j &= \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{v}_j} \tilde{H} = - \left(1 - \frac{\tilde{u}_j \tilde{v}_j}{4} \right) \tilde{u}_j - \frac{1}{4} \prod_{k=1, k \neq j}^4 \tilde{v}_k, \\
\frac{\partial}{\partial \xi} \tilde{v}_j &= - \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{u}_j} \tilde{H} = \left(1 - \frac{\tilde{u}_j \tilde{v}_j}{4} \right) \tilde{v}_j + \frac{1}{4} \prod_{k=1, k \neq j}^4 \tilde{u}_k,
\end{aligned} \tag{7.14}$$

which conserves the Hamiltonian $\tilde{H}$ and, for constants $\tilde{\gamma}_j$, three intermodal power differences (read as $j > k$ to avoid over counting):

$$\tilde{u}_j(\xi) \tilde{v}_j(\xi) - \tilde{u}_k(\xi) \tilde{v}_k(\xi) = \tilde{\gamma}_j - \tilde{\gamma}_k. \tag{7.15}$$

We now consider a degeneration and rescaling of this FWM system defined by the following substitutions in the Hamiltonian in (7.13) (note the bar notation on the right and the tilde notation on the left):

$$\begin{aligned}
\chi \xi &= z, \\
\tilde{u}_1(\xi) &= \varsigma \sqrt{2} \chi \bar{u}_1(z), \\
\tilde{u}_2(\xi) &= \sqrt{2} \chi \bar{u}_2(z), \\
\tilde{u}_3(\xi) &= \chi \bar{u}_3(z), \\
\tilde{u}_4(\xi) &= \chi \bar{u}_3(z), \\
\tilde{v}_1(\xi) &= \varsigma \sqrt{2} \chi \bar{v}_1(z), \\
\tilde{v}_2(\xi) &= \sqrt{2} \chi \bar{v}_2(z), \\
\tilde{v}_3(\xi) &= \chi \bar{v}_3(z), \\
\tilde{v}_4(\xi) &= \chi \bar{v}_3(z),
\end{aligned} \tag{7.16}$$

where $\varsigma = \pm 1$, χ is a free parameter, and $\tilde{u}_3$ and $\tilde{u}_4$ coalesce to $\bar{u}_3$ (likewise for the corresponding conjugates) to create degeneracy and reduce four degrees of freedom (modes) to three. We then divide the Hamiltonian by $2\chi^3$. The division by $2\chi^3$ has two parts. The factor $2\chi^2$ comes from the rescaling of the dependent variables as differentiating the substituted Hamiltonian with respect to $\bar{u}_j$ or $\bar{v}_j$ brings down the same factor that appears in the product of the corresponding $\tilde{u}_j, \tilde{v}_j$ scalings. Dividing by this factor restores the canonical Hamilton equations for the barred variables. The remaining factor χ comes from the change of propagation variable $z = \chi \xi$. We thus obtain the following degenerate FWM system that we consider for our projection:

$$\bar{H} = \frac{\tilde{H}}{2\chi^3} = -\frac{\varsigma \chi}{4} (\bar{u}_1 \bar{u}_2 \bar{u}_3^2 + \bar{v}_1 \bar{v}_2 \bar{v}_3^2) + \frac{\chi \bar{u}_1^2 \bar{v}_1^2}{4} + \frac{\chi \bar{u}_2^2 \bar{v}_2^2}{4} + \frac{\chi \bar{u}_3^2 \bar{v}_3^2}{8} - \frac{1}{\chi} \sum_{j=1}^3 \bar{u}_j \bar{v}_j, \tag{7.17}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{\partial}{\partial z} \bar{u}_j(z) &= \frac{\partial}{\partial \bar{v}_j} \bar{H}, \\
\frac{\partial}{\partial z} \bar{v}_j(z) &= - \frac{\partial}{\partial \bar{u}_j} \bar{H},
\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{\partial}{\partial z} \bar{u}_1(z) &= -\frac{\bar{u}_1}{\chi} + \frac{\chi \bar{u}_1^2 \bar{v}_1}{2} - \frac{\varsigma \chi \bar{v}_2 \bar{v}_3^2}{4}, \\
\frac{\partial}{\partial z} \bar{u}_2(z) &= -\frac{\bar{u}_2}{\chi} + \frac{\chi \bar{u}_2^2 \bar{v}_2}{2} - \frac{\varsigma \chi \bar{v}_1 \bar{v}_3^2}{4}, \\
\frac{\partial}{\partial z} \bar{u}_3(z) &= -\frac{\bar{u}_3}{\chi} + \frac{\chi \bar{u}_3^2 \bar{v}_3}{4} - \frac{\varsigma \chi \bar{v}_1 \bar{v}_2 \bar{v}_3}{2}, \\
\frac{\partial}{\partial z} \bar{v}_1(z) &= \frac{\bar{v}_1}{\chi} - \frac{\chi \bar{v}_1^2 \bar{u}_1}{2} + \frac{\varsigma \chi \bar{u}_2 \bar{u}_3^2}{4}, \\
\frac{\partial}{\partial z} \bar{v}_2(z) &= \frac{\bar{v}_2}{\chi} - \frac{\chi \bar{v}_2^2 \bar{u}_2}{2} + \frac{\varsigma \chi \bar{u}_1 \bar{u}_3^2}{4}, \\
\frac{\partial}{\partial z} \bar{v}_3(z) &= \frac{\bar{v}_3}{\chi} - \frac{\chi \bar{v}_3^2 \bar{u}_3}{4} + \frac{\varsigma \chi \bar{u}_1 \bar{u}_2 \bar{u}_3}{2},
\end{aligned} \tag{7.18}$$

There is a projection from (7.18) to (3.1) which we will now describe.

Let us define modes $\hat{u}_j, \hat{v}_j$ with $j = 1, 2$ (note the hat notation), in terms of $\bar{u}_k, \bar{v}_k$ modes with $k = 1, 2, 3$, as follows:

$$\begin{aligned}
\hat{u}_1(z) &= \frac{\sqrt{2}\sqrt{\gamma_1 - \lambda_1} \bar{u}_1(z) e^{z\theta}}{\bar{v}_3(z)}, \\
\hat{u}_2(z) &= \frac{\sqrt{2}\sqrt{\gamma_2 - \lambda_1} \bar{u}_2(z) e^{-z\theta}}{\bar{v}_3(z)}, \\
\hat{v}_1(z) &= \frac{\sqrt{2}\sqrt{\gamma_1 - \lambda_1} \bar{v}_1(z) e^{-z\theta}}{\bar{u}_3(z)}, \\
\hat{v}_2(z) &= \frac{\sqrt{2}\sqrt{\gamma_2 - \lambda_1} \bar{v}_2(z) e^{z\theta}}{\bar{u}_3(z)},
\end{aligned} \tag{7.19}$$

where:

$$\theta = -b_2 \gamma_1 + \frac{2\gamma_1}{b_0 + b_1 \lambda_1 + b_2 \lambda_1^2}, \tag{7.20}$$

and where $\gamma_1, \gamma_2, b_0, b_1, b_2$ all retain their definitions given in Appendices A and B for the two mode coherent coupler system, and λ_1 remains the chosen root of (5.7). Let us then set the values of the conserved quantities in the degenerate FWM system (bar coordinates) in terms of parameters from the coherent coupler system (hat coordinates). To do this, we first define the constant d_5 in terms of λ_1 and the other d_j parameters from the coherent coupler system given in Appendix A such that:

$$d_5 = d_1 + 2d_2 \lambda_1 + 3d_3 \lambda_1^2 + 4d_4 \lambda_1^3, \tag{7.21}$$

then we fix the following relationship between the intermodal power constants $\bar{\gamma}_j$ in the degenerate FWM system and the γ_k of the coherent coupler system such that:

$$\begin{aligned}
\bar{u}_1 \bar{v}_1 - \bar{u}_2 \bar{v}_2 &= \bar{\gamma}_1 - \bar{\gamma}_2 = \frac{d_5 \gamma_1}{4(\gamma_1^2 - \lambda_1^2)}, \\
2\bar{u}_1 \bar{v}_1 - \bar{u}_3 \bar{v}_3 &= 2\bar{\gamma}_1 - \bar{\gamma}_3 = \frac{d_5}{4(\gamma_1 - \lambda_1)}, \\
2\bar{u}_2 \bar{v}_2 - \bar{u}_3 \bar{v}_3 &= 2\bar{\gamma}_2 - \bar{\gamma}_3 = \frac{d_5}{4(\gamma_2 - \lambda_1)},
\end{aligned} \tag{7.22}$$

where, by definition:

$$\sum_{j=1}^3 \bar{\gamma}_j = \sum_{j=1}^2 \gamma_j = 0. \tag{7.23}$$

We then fix the free parameter χ and the sign parameter $\varsigma = \pm 1$ in the degenerate FWM system in terms of parameters from the coherent coupler system such that:

$$\chi = \frac{8(b_0 + b_1\lambda_1 + b_2\lambda_1^2)}{d_5}, \quad (7.24)$$

$$\varsigma = \frac{2\sqrt{\gamma_2 - \lambda_1}\sqrt{\gamma_1 - \lambda_1}}{b_0 + b_1\lambda_1 + b_2\lambda_1^2}, \quad (7.25)$$

and the Hamiltonian in the degenerate FWM system takes the value:

$$\bar{H} = -\frac{b_2 d_5}{8} - \frac{2}{\chi} + \frac{64(d_5 + 16\lambda_1)\lambda_1}{\chi^3 d_5^2}. \quad (7.26)$$

With these parameter relationships the projection is defined. Differentiating (7.19) with respect to z , substituting (7.18) into the right-hand side, replacing ratios of bar-coordinate modes by hat-coordinate modes using (7.19), and simplifying using the Hamiltonian in (7.17), recovers the two-mode coherent coupler system in (7.8). This establishes a projection from degenerate FWM to the coherent coupler.

The solutions to (7.18) are for $j = 1, 2, 3$:

$$\begin{aligned} \bar{u}_j(z) &= \sqrt{\frac{s(j)}{2}} \frac{\bar{\alpha}_j \sigma(z - 2z_0 + \mu_j) e^{z\left(\frac{\chi \bar{\gamma}_j}{s(j)} - \zeta(\mu_j - z_0) + \frac{1}{\chi}\right)}}{\sigma(\mu_j - z_0) \sigma(z - z_0)}, \\ \bar{v}_j(z) &= \sqrt{\frac{s(j)}{2}} \frac{\sigma(z - \mu_j) e^{-z\left(\frac{\chi \bar{\gamma}_j}{s(j)} - \zeta(\mu_j - z_0) + \frac{1}{\chi}\right)}}{\bar{\alpha}_j \sigma(\mu_j - z_0) \sigma(z - z_0)}, \\ \bar{u}_j(z) \bar{v}_j(z) &= \frac{s(j)}{2} (\wp(\mu_j - z_0) - \wp(z - z_0)) \end{aligned} \quad (7.27)$$

where $\bar{\alpha}_j$ is an integration constant that captures initial relative phase offsets between modes and can be used to equate initial conditions between the degenerate FWM and coherent coupler systems. The function $s(j)$ is the degeneracy weight, with $s(1) = s(2) = 1$ and $s(3) = 2$, and the new third μ_j constant is $\mu_3 = z_1 + z_0$. The elliptic functions use invariants g_2, g_3 , and $\mu_1, \mu_2, z_0, z_1, g_2, g_3$ share the same definitions and values as those given in Section 5 for the coherent coupler, thereby connecting the two systems. The solutions in (7.27) take the form of Kronecker theta functions, which are ratios of two Weierstrass σ functions with shifted arguments, multiplied by exponential factors. These functions are named after Kronecker, who developed both Fourier series [7] and multipole-expansion [9, 10] representations that may prove useful for further analysis in nonlinear optics. Importantly, while the σ functions and exponentials are entire functions, their ratio is a single-valued meromorphic function with well-defined poles and zeros, in contrast to the multi-valued solutions in (6.7). The solutions are quasi-periodic, and modulo the period lattice they have zeros where the numerator σ function vanishes and poles where the denominator σ function vanishes.

The Kronecker theta form establishes a direct connection with other integrable nonlinear optical systems, including two-wave and three-wave mixing in quadratic nonlinear media, polarisation dynamics in nonlinear fibres, and parity-time symmetric nonlinear couplers [3], suggesting a unified mathematical framework across different parametric processes.

8 Numerical validation and implementation

In this section we validate the analytic solutions through numerical evaluation and demonstrate their practical implementation using open-source software. This serves two purposes: first, to verify that the solutions correctly satisfy the differential equations, and second, to show that the Weierstrass elliptic functions can be readily evaluated using standard numerical libraries.

We evaluate the analytic solutions using the *pyweierstrass* Python package [11], which provides Weierstrass elliptic functions as a wrapper around Jacobi theta functions from the *mpmath* package [12]. For comparison, we solve the differential equations numerically using the DOP853 Runge-Kutta algorithm from *SciPy* [13].

For plotting purposes we define the following complex-valued functions $\mathcal{P}_j(z)$, $\phi_j(z) \in \mathbb{C}$ that are analogous to modal power (absolute value squared) and phase; they would be equivalent to the corresponding real-valued functions if v_j were the complex conjugate of u_j rather than the more general Hamiltonian conjugate that we typically consider in our generalised systems:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{P}_j(z) &= u_j(z)v_j(z), \\ \phi_j(z) &= \frac{\log\left(\frac{u_j(z)}{v_j(z)}\right)}{2i}.\end{aligned}\tag{8.1}$$

The top row of Figure 1 shows the real, **A**, and imaginary, **B**, parts of the complex mode power $\mathcal{P}_j$, while the bottom row shows the real, **C**, and imaginary, **D**, parts of the complex phase variable ϕ_j , using the analytic solutions in (6.7) compared against numerical integration of the original general coherent coupler system in (3.1). The intermodal power conservation laws in (4.7) are evident from the coordinated evolution of the two modes. The initial mode and parameter values for this plot were $u_1(0) = 0.487 - 0.828i$, $u_2(0) = -0.971 - 0.865i$, $v_1(0) = 0.942 + 0.279i$, $v_2(0) = 0.386 - 0.523i$, $a_1 = -0.161$, $a_2 = -0.897$, $a_{1,1} = 0.583$, $a_{1,2} = a_{2,1} = -0.0754$, and $a_{2,2} = -0.0525$.

The top row of Figure 2 shows the real, **A**, and imaginary, **B**, parts of the complex mode power $\mathcal{P}_j$, while the bottom row shows the real, **C**, and imaginary, **D**, parts of the complex phase variable ϕ_j , using the gauge transformed analytic solutions in (7.11) compared against numerical integration of the gauge transformed general coherent coupler system in (7.8). Here, $\hat{u}_j, \hat{v}_j$ are used in place of u_j, v_j in (8.1). The initial values of $\hat{u}_j, \hat{v}_j$ were set equal to the values of u_j, v_j used in Figure 1 and the $a_1, a_2, a_{1,1}, a_{1,2}, a_{2,1}$, and $a_{2,2}$ parameters were the same in all figures. In comparison with Figure 1, the modal power $\mathcal{P}_j$ is unchanged after the gauge transform but the phase ϕ_j changes as expected from the definition of the transform.

The top row of Figure 3 shows the real, **A**, and imaginary, **B**, parts of the complex mode power $\mathcal{P}_j$, while the bottom row shows the real, **C**, and imaginary, **D**, parts of the complex phase variable ϕ_j , using the analytic solutions in (7.27) compared against numerical integration of the three-mode degenerate FWM system in (7.18). Here, $\bar{u}_j, \bar{v}_j$ are used in place of u_j, v_j in (8.1). The corresponding intermodal power conservation laws are evident from the coordinated evolution of the three modes. We set $\bar{u}_3(0) = \sigma(z_0 - z_1)/(\sigma(z_0)\sigma(z_1))$, and the remaining initial conditions for the other modes in the bar coordinates are then determined using (7.19), where the values for $\hat{u}_j(0), \hat{v}_j(0)$ and all other parameters share the same values as those used in Figure 2.

Finally, the top row of Figure 4 shows the real, **A**, and imaginary, **B**, parts of the mode power $\mathcal{P}_j$, while the bottom row shows the real, **C**, and imaginary, **D**, parts of the phase variable ϕ_j , using the analytic solutions in (6.8) and the relations in (3.2), compared against numerical integration of Jensen's original system in (2.1). Here, A_j, A_j^* are used in place of u_j, v_j in (8.1) and thus in this case those variables reduce to absolute magnitude squared and the genuine phase, i.e., both become real variables as confirmed by no imaginary parts observed in Figure 4 **B** and **D**. The initial mode and parameter values for this plot were $A_1(0) = 0.731 - 0.513i$, $A_2(0) = 0.551 + 0.967i$, $\Omega_1 = 0.462$, $\Omega_2 = -0.00783$, $\Omega_3 = -0.541$, and $\Omega_4 = 0.252$.

In Figures 1–4 the analytic solutions (lines) are in excellent agreement with the numerical solutions (symbols). For the parameter sets shown in Figures 1–4, the maximum pointwise absolute discrepancy between the analytic solution vectors and the DOP853 numerical solutions, over the plotted interval and sampled points, was approximately 10^{-13} , 10^{-13} , 10^{-14} , and 10^{-15} , respectively. These comparisons confirm both the correctness of the analytic solutions and the feasibility of their numerical evaluation using readily available software tools.

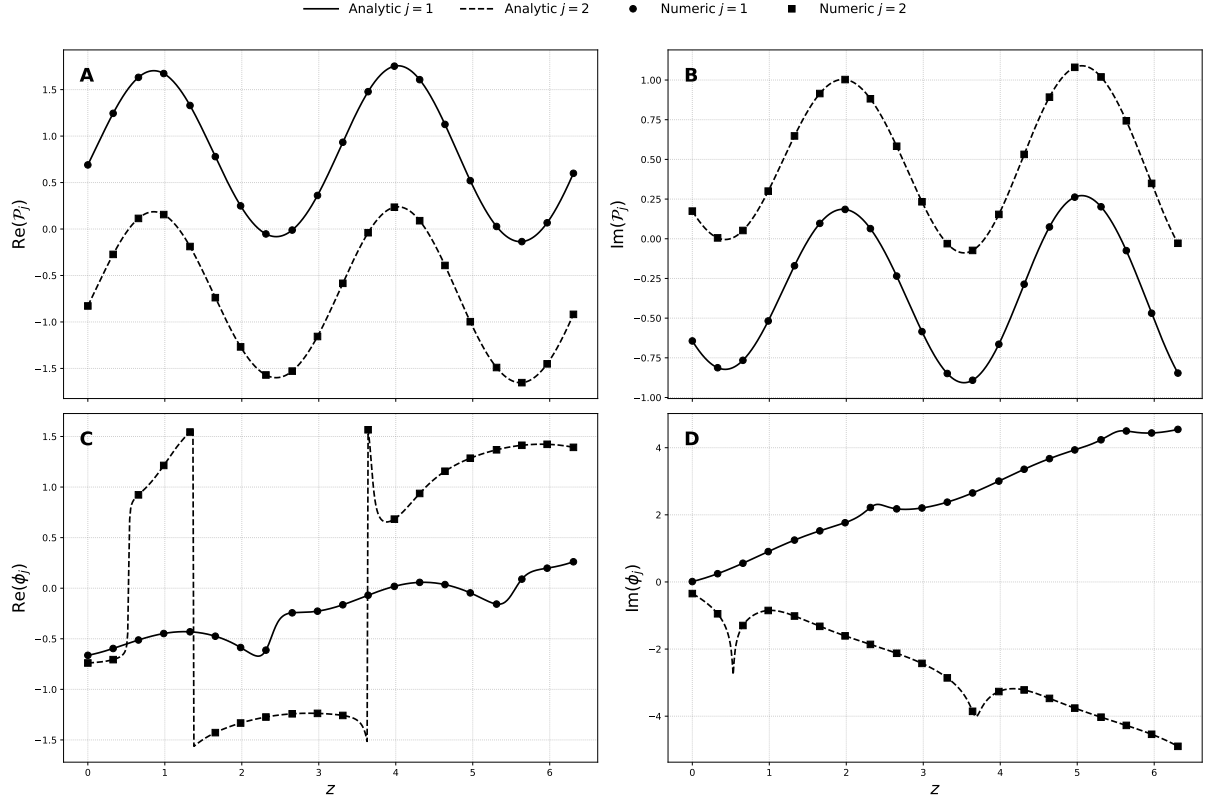


Figure 1: **A** real and **B** imaginary parts of the complex mode power $\mathcal{P}_j$, and **C** real and **D** imaginary parts of the complex phase variable ϕ_j , using the analytic solutions in (6.7) (lines) compared against numerical integration of the original general coherent coupler system in (3.1) (symbols).

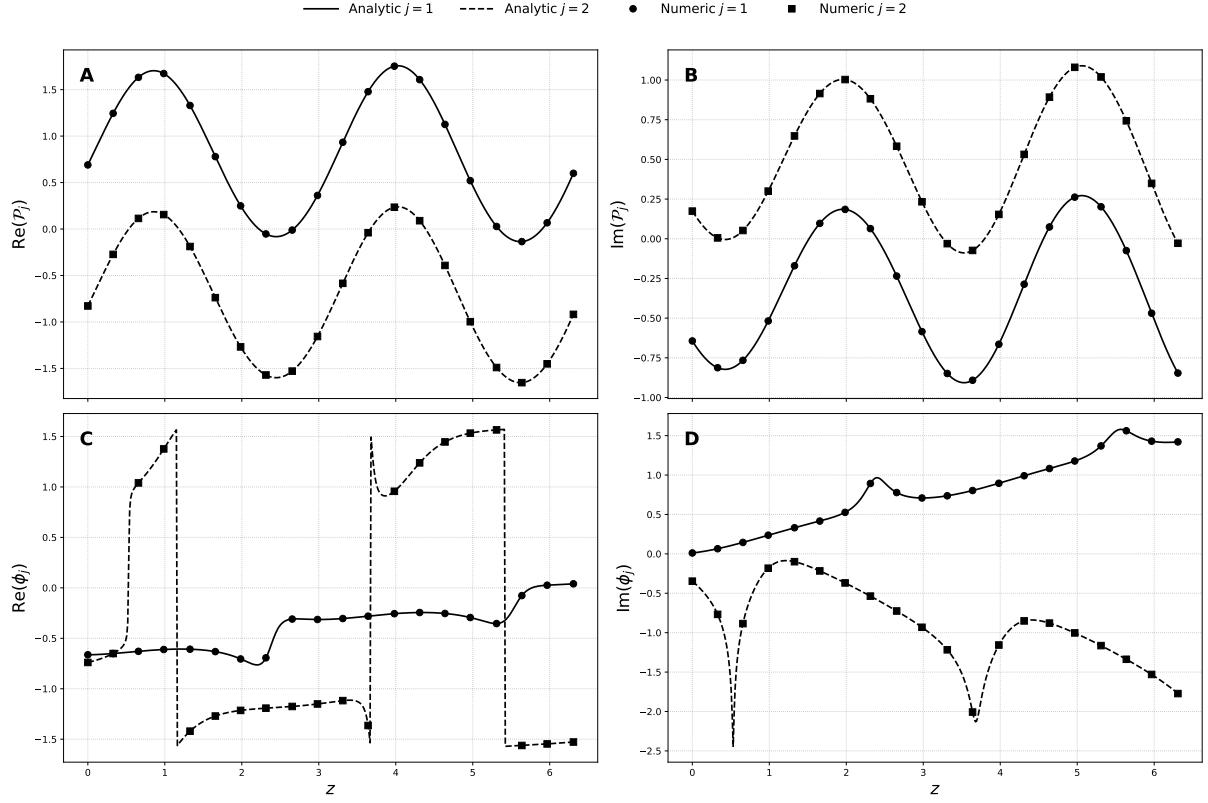


Figure 2: **A** real and **B** imaginary parts of the complex mode power $\mathcal{P}_j$, and **C** real and **D** imaginary parts of the complex phase variable ϕ_j , using the gauge transformed analytic solutions in (7.11) (lines) compared against numerical integration of the gauge transformed general coherent coupler system in (7.8) (symbols).

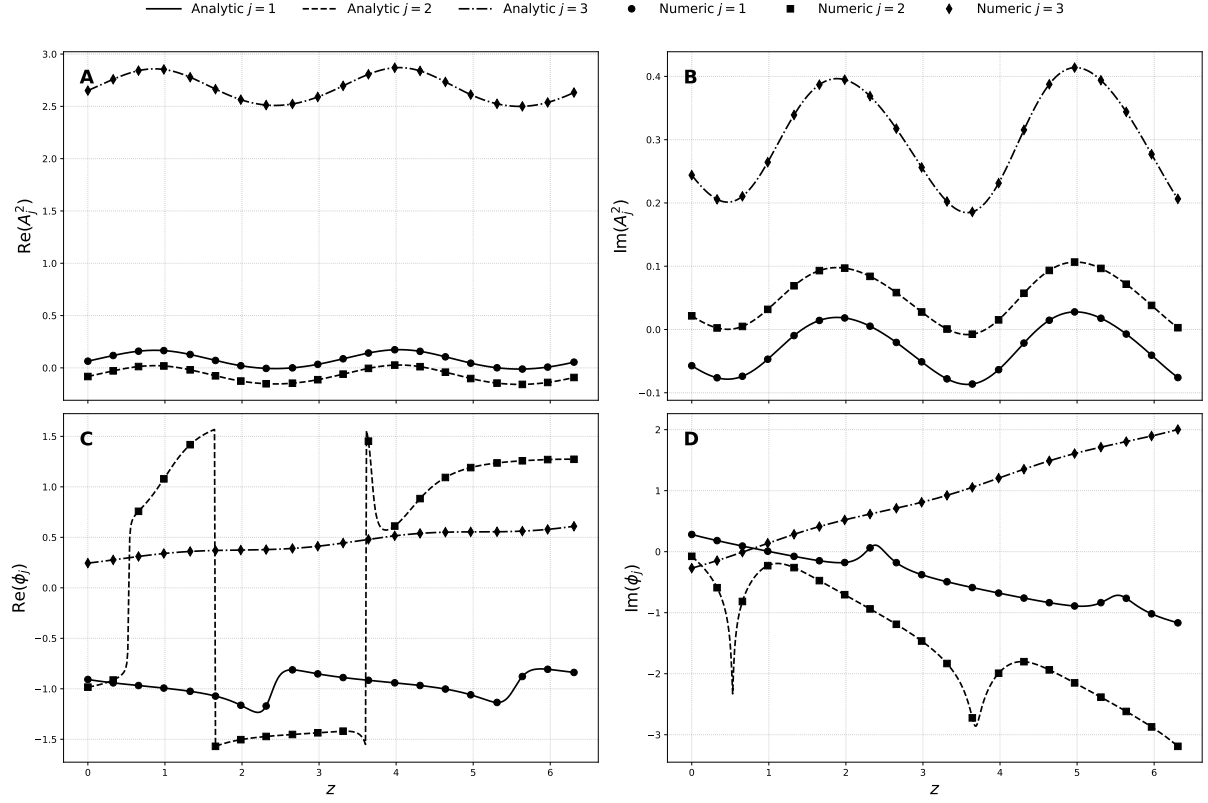


Figure 3: **A** real and **B** imaginary parts of the complex mode power $\mathcal{P}_j$, and **C** real and **D** imaginary parts of the complex phase variable ϕ_j , using the analytic solutions in (7.27) (lines) compared against numerical integration of the three-mode degenerate FWM system in (7.18) (symbols).

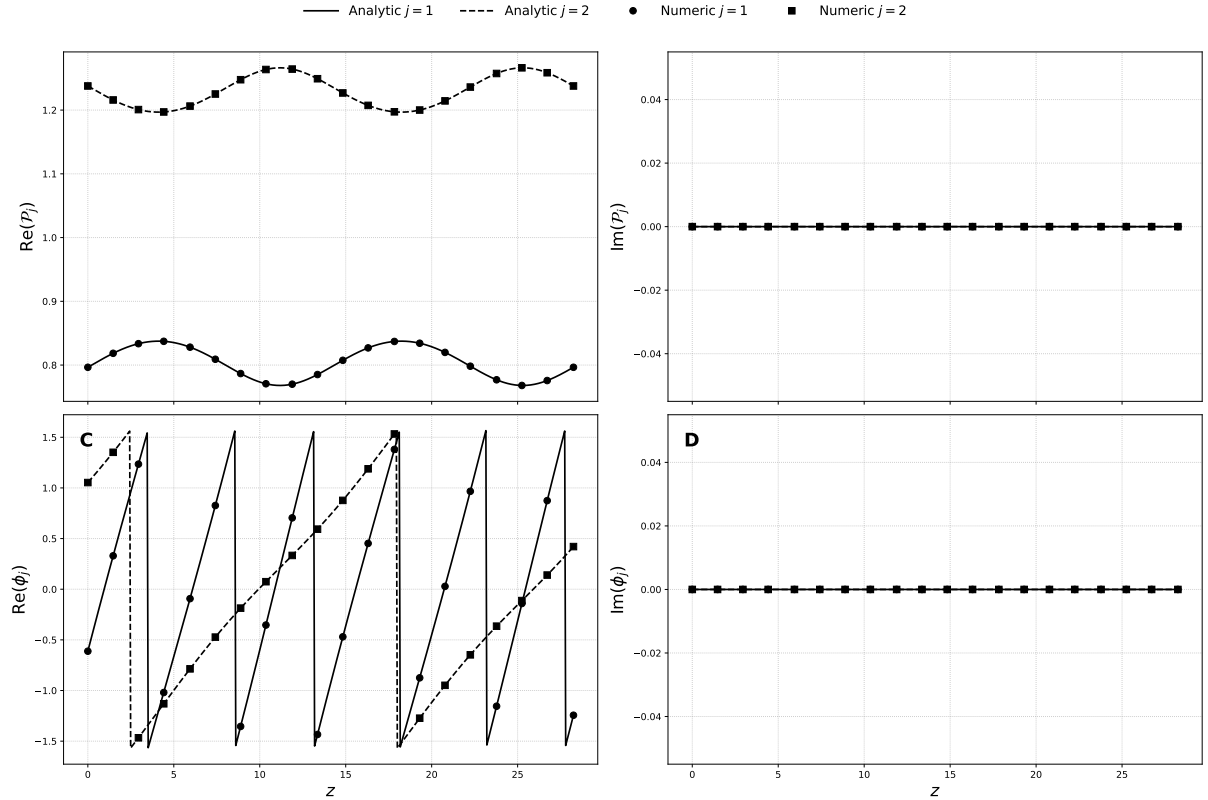


Figure 4: **A** real and **B** imaginary parts of the mode power $\mathcal{P}_j$, and **C** real and **D** imaginary parts of the phase variable ϕ_j , using the analytic solutions in (6.8) and the relations in (3.2) (lines) compared against numerical integration of Jensen’s original system in (2.1) (symbols).

9 Conclusion

We have presented complete analytic solutions for the generalised coherent coupler in nonlinear optics without the symmetric-parameter assumptions used in many treatments. The solutions, expressed in terms of Weierstrass elliptic functions, provide the full complex field envelopes for all modes under generic initial conditions, including cross-phase modulation and phase mismatch effects. These solutions complement previous work in the literature by providing a unified treatment of the complex envelopes themselves rather than treating amplitudes and phases separately.

Guided by the structure of these solutions, we explored coordinate transformations that use a gauge transform to remove multi-valued branching behaviour in solutions and reveal a projection from degenerate FWM to the gauge transformed coherent coupler. The solutions in the degenerate FWM system are single-valued meromorphic Kronecker theta functions, connecting this work to a broader class of integrable nonlinear optical systems.

The connection between the Hamiltonian formulation and the Frobenius-Stickelberger determinant, established in Appendix C, provides deeper insight into why these conservation laws hold and links the coherent coupler to classical elliptic function theory. This mathematical framework may prove valuable for analysing related parametric processes.

The methods developed here may be applicable to related nonlinear systems. In particular, the approach may be transferable to the analysis of mode coupling in multimode nonlinear fibre optics (see, e.g., Chapter 4 in [2]), where similar coupled-mode structures arise.

The practical utility of these solutions has been demonstrated through numerical evaluation using open-source Python libraries, confirming both their validity and computational accessibility. These analytic solutions may provide new insights for the design and optimisation of

nonlinear coherent couplers by enabling exact analysis of all-optical switching, nonlinear power transfer, and coherent quantum-optical phenomena in regimes where approximate models prove inadequate.

Acknowledgements

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Code Availability

The code used in this paper is available at [14] and includes Python Jupyter notebooks with symbolic derivations using *SymPy* [15] as well as the code for numerical validation used in Section 8.

A Parameter definitions in the original coordinates

This appendix provides explicit formulae for the parameters b_l , c_l , and d_l that appear in the quartic polynomial (5.5) and related expressions throughout Section 5. These parameters are expressed in terms of the system parameters a_j , $a_{j,k}$ and the conserved constants γ_j .

$$N = 2, \tag{A.1}$$

$$b_0 = a_0 + \sum_{j=1}^N a_j \gamma_j + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{j,k=1}^N a_{j,k} \gamma_j \gamma_k,$$

$$b_1 = -\sum_{j=1}^N a_j - \frac{1}{2} \sum_{j,k=1}^N (\gamma_j + \gamma_k) a_{j,k},$$

$$b_2 = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{j,k=1}^N a_{j,k},$$

$$c_0 = \prod_{j=1}^N \gamma_j,$$

$$d_0 = b_0^2 - 4c_0,$$

$$d_1 = 2b_0 b_1,$$

$$d_2 = 2b_0 b_2 + b_1^2 - 4,$$

$$d_3 = 2b_1 b_2,$$

$$d_4 = b_2^2 \tag{A.2}$$

B Initial condition relations

This appendix gives the relationships between initial conditions for the physical system and the constants γ_j and $\rho(0)$ used throughout the analysis. These relations enable determination of the constants from specified initial values of $u_j(0)$ and $v_j(0)$.

$$\begin{aligned}
N &= 2, \\
\rho(0) &= -\frac{1}{N} \sum_{j=1}^N u_j(0) v_j(0), \\
\left. \frac{d}{dz} \rho(z) \right|_{z=0} &= \prod_{j=1}^N u_j(0) - \prod_{j=1}^N v_j(0), \\
\gamma_j &= u_j(0) v_j(0) + \rho(0)
\end{aligned} \tag{B.1}$$

C The Frobenius-Stickelberger determinant

The Frobenius-Stickelberger (FS) determinant formula is an elliptic function identity relating products of σ functions to determinants of derivatives of $\wp$ [7, 16]. In this appendix we demonstrate that the conservation of the Hamiltonian can be viewed as a manifestation of this classical identity, providing a deeper structural understanding of why the Hamiltonian is conserved in the coherent coupler.

Our starting point is equation (C.4), which relates the wave mixing product to the phase modulation terms via the Hamiltonian. We show that this equation can be transformed into the FS determinant formula by treating the left-hand side (the product of modes) and right-hand side (the polynomial in ρ) separately, each ultimately expressed in terms of Weierstrass functions.

We are interested in the 4×4 case of FS in the form:

$$\frac{C \sigma(z + \nu_1) \sigma(z + \nu_2) \sigma(z + \nu_3) \sigma(z - \nu_1 - \nu_2 - \nu_3)}{\sigma^4(z)} = \det M \tag{C.1}$$

where:

$$C = \frac{12 \sigma(\nu_1 - \nu_2) \sigma(\nu_1 - \nu_3) \sigma(\nu_2 - \nu_3)}{\sigma(\nu_1) \sigma^4(\nu_2) \sigma^4(\nu_3)} \tag{C.2}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
\det M &= \begin{vmatrix} 1 & \wp(z) & \frac{\partial \wp(z)}{\partial z} & \frac{\partial^2 \wp(z)}{\partial z^2} \\ 1 & \wp(\nu_1) & -\frac{\partial \wp(\nu_1)}{\partial \nu_1} & \frac{\partial^2 \wp(\nu_1)}{\partial \nu_1^2} \\ 1 & \wp(\nu_2) & -\frac{\partial \wp(\nu_2)}{\partial \nu_2} & \frac{\partial^2 \wp(\nu_2)}{\partial \nu_2^2} \\ 1 & \wp(\nu_3) & -\frac{\partial \wp(\nu_3)}{\partial \nu_3} & \frac{\partial^2 \wp(\nu_3)}{\partial \nu_3^2} \end{vmatrix} \\
&= -6 (\wp(\nu_1) - \wp(z)) (\wp(\nu_2) - \wp(z)) (\wp(\nu_1) - \wp(\nu_2)) \wp'(\nu_3) \\
&\quad + 6 (\wp(\nu_1) - \wp(z)) (\wp(\nu_3) - \wp(z)) (\wp(\nu_1) - \wp(\nu_3)) \wp'(\nu_2) \\
&\quad - 6 (\wp(\nu_2) - \wp(z)) (\wp(\nu_3) - \wp(z)) (\wp(\nu_2) - \wp(\nu_3)) \wp'(\nu_1) \\
&\quad - 6 (\wp(\nu_1) - \wp(\nu_2)) (\wp(\nu_1) - \wp(\nu_3)) (\wp(\nu_2) - \wp(\nu_3)) \wp'(z)
\end{aligned} \tag{C.3}$$

The starting point for us is the following relation established via (4.1), (4.5), and (5.2), where any choice of j may be used in the modal-power derivative:

$$\begin{aligned}
2 \prod_{k=1}^2 u_k &= a_0 + \sum_{k=1}^2 a_k u_k v_k + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{k,l=1}^2 a_{k,l} u_k v_k u_l v_l - \frac{\partial}{\partial z} (u_j v_j) \\
&= \rho' + \sum_{l=0}^2 b_l \rho(z)^l.
\end{aligned} \tag{C.4}$$

We now transform (C.4) into (C.1).

C.1 The left-hand side

From (5.15), the right-hand side of (C.4) is a doubly periodic elliptic function, and therefore so is the left-hand side. Thus for integers m, n and half-periods ω_1, ω_3 we must have:

$$\prod_{j=1}^2 \frac{u_j(z)}{u_j(2m\omega_3 + 2n\omega_1 + z)} = 1. \quad (\text{C.5})$$

We substitute our solution (6.7) into (C.5), take advantage of (6.10) to simplify, and use the quasi-periodicity of σ :

$$\sigma(2m\omega_3 + 2n\omega_1 + z) = (-1)^{mn+m+n} \sigma(z) e^{(2m\omega_3 + 2n\omega_1 + 2z)\zeta(m\omega_3 + n\omega_1)} \quad (\text{C.6})$$

to reduce the product in (C.5) to an exponential which, as it is equal to one, must have argument $2\pi i N(n, m)$, with $N(n, m)$ an integer that varies with n, m . For the lattice displacement determined by $2z_1 + \nu_1 + \nu_2$, this gives:

$$2i\pi N(n, m) = -2 \left(2z_1 + \sum_{j=1}^2 \nu_j \right) \zeta(m\omega_3 + n\omega_1, g_2, g_3) - (2m\omega_3 + 2n\omega_1) \sum_{j=1}^2 r_{0,j}, \quad (\text{C.7})$$

$$2z_1 + \sum_{j=1}^2 \nu_j = 2m\omega_3 + 2n\omega_1 = 0 \pmod{\text{lattice}}, \quad (\text{C.8})$$

$$\sum_{j=1}^2 r_{0,j} = -2\zeta(m\omega_3 + n\omega_1, g_2, g_3). \quad (\text{C.9})$$

where $\nu_j = \mu_j - z_0$, and where the integers m, n in (C.8) specify the relevant lattice point rather than arbitrary independent periods. In moving from (C.7) to (C.8) and (C.9) we made use of the identity $\zeta(\omega_3)\omega_1 - \zeta(\omega_1)\omega_3 = i\pi/2$. Ultimately, equations (C.6), (C.8) and (C.9) allow us to make the following substitution (or the equivalent at $z \rightarrow z - z_0$) in the left-hand side of (C.4):

$$\frac{\sigma(z + z_1)}{\sigma(z_1)} \exp \left(z \sum_{j=1}^2 r_{0,j} \right) = - \frac{\sigma(z - z_1 - \nu_1 - \nu_2)}{\sigma(z_1 + \nu_1 + \nu_2)}. \quad (\text{C.10})$$

C.2 The right-hand side

The following polynomial interpolation formula holds for any quadratic polynomial:

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{l=0}^2 b_l \rho(z)^l &= \frac{\gamma_1 - \rho(z)}{\gamma_1 - \gamma_2} \sum_{l=0}^2 b_l \gamma_1^l + \\ &\quad \frac{\gamma_2 - \rho(z)}{\gamma_2 - \gamma_1} \sum_{l=0}^2 b_l \gamma_2^l + \\ &\quad (\gamma_1 - \rho(z)) (\gamma_2 - \rho(z)) b_2 \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.11})$$

where, in our case, $\gamma_j = \rho(\mu_j)$ and the sum over $b_l \gamma_j^l$ can be written using (5.4) as:

$$\sum_{l=0}^2 b_l \gamma_j^l = \rho'(\mu_j). \quad (\text{C.12})$$

We can then use (5.15) to express ρ in terms of $\wp$ so that all variables in (C.11) can be written in terms of $\wp$ and $\wp'$. We then divide both sides of (C.4) by:

$$\frac{\wp'(z_1)}{b_2 (\wp(z_1) - \wp(z - z_0))^2} \quad (\text{C.13})$$

and observe that it takes the equivalent form to (C.1) up to constant factors that may look different but can be shown to be identical by evaluating at $z \rightarrow z + z_0$, multiplying by $\sigma(z)^4$, and taking $z \rightarrow 0$.

This completes the demonstration that the Hamiltonian conservation law (C.4) is equivalent to the Frobenius-Stickelberger determinant formula. This connection reveals that the conserved Hamiltonian of the coherent coupler is not merely a convenient construct but rather a manifestation of deep structural properties of elliptic functions.

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